

NEXUS EOC

User Interface Guide — Fields, Panels, and Interactions

This document describes every panel, field, and interactive element in NEXUS EOC. Setup screen fields are listed in the order they appear on screen.

SETUP SCREEN — SESSION FLOW

The setup screen follows the natural sequence of an EOC activation: the incident happens first, then the jurisdiction defines your resources, then you report to your role. Fields appear in this order:

1. Scenario → 2. Jurisdiction & Difficulty → 3. Role → 4. Commander Name → 5. Documentation → 6. Launch

SETUP SCREEN — SCENARIO & CONFIGURATION

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Scenario Cards	Selection	Choose the incident type. Each card shows the scenario name, icon, and a description of the operating environment. Jurisdiction and role will determine how this scenario plays out.	Click any card to select. Selected card highlights with a green left border and dot. Click another to change.
Jurisdiction Type	Dropdown	Sets the operating environment. Drives AI world generation — determines the specific location, named agencies, resource constraints, and legal authorities for the session.	Select from: Rural County, Mid-Size City, Large Urban Metro, Coastal Community, Tribal Nation, Interstate Corridor.
Jurisdiction Description	Auto-display	Describes the selected jurisdiction including population context, resource base, and key operational constraints. Updates when jurisdiction changes.	Read-only.
Difficulty	Dropdown	Sets how rigorously the AI evaluates decisions and how many complications surface each turn.	Select from: Basic (1 complication), Moderate (2), Advanced (2-3, professional rigor), Brutal (ruthless), Adaptive (scales to your performance).
Difficulty Description	Auto-display	One-sentence explanation of what the selected difficulty means in practice.	Read-only. Updates automatically.

SETUP SCREEN — ROLE SELECTOR

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Role Selector	Grouped dropdown	Select your position in the EOC activation. The AI calibrates scenario complications, decision evaluation, and after-action review to your selected role. Two groups: EOC Leadership (8 roles) and ESF Liaison Officers (all 15 ESFs).	Click dropdown and select your role. Defaults to EOC Director. Role description appears below the dropdown.
EOC Leadership Roles	Role group	EOC Director, Operations Section Chief, Planning Section Chief, Logistics Section Chief, Finance & Admin Section Chief, Public Information Officer, Safety Officer, Liaison Officer.	Select from the EOC Leadership group in the dropdown.
ESF Liaison Officers	Role group	All 15 ESF Liaison Officers (ESF-1 through ESF-15) as defined in the National Response Framework. Each receives role-specific complications and ESF-calibrated after-action review.	Select from the ESF Liaison Officers group in the dropdown.
Role Description	Auto-display	One-sentence description of the selected role's responsibilities and span of control.	Read-only. Updates when role changes.

SETUP SCREEN — COMMANDER NAME & DOCS

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Commander Name	Text input	Optional. Enter your name to personalize the session. Your name appears in the terminal header and after-action review. Not stored — local to your browser session only.	Click and type your name (max 40 characters). Leave blank to play anonymously.
Privacy Disclosure	Display	Confirms that your name is used locally only and that only anonymous play statistics are collected.	Read-only.
Platform Overview	Document link	One-page summary of NEXUS EOC — what it is, key features, and who it is for. Opens in a new browser tab.	Click to open PDF in new tab.
User Guide	Document link	Full interface reference — this document. Opens in a new browser tab.	Click to open PDF in new tab.
Resource Guide	Document link	All reference links organized by scenario, plus general EM doctrine resources. Downloads as Excel.	Click to download Excel file.

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Launch Button	Action	Initiates scenario generation. AI builds a location-specific world based on your selections. Button shows your scenario, jurisdiction, and role when ready.	Click when scenario is selected. Shows loading state while world generates (3-10 seconds). Input is disabled during generation.
Bottom Status Bar	Display	Shows current selections live: EOC Network, Mode, Scenario, Jurisdiction, Role, Difficulty, and Status.	Read-only. Updates as selections change.

COMMUNITY LIFELINES BAR

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Lifeline Tiles (x8)	Display/Hover	Real-time status of all 8 FEMA Community Lifelines. GREEN = operational, YELLOW = degraded, RED = compromised. Updated every turn by the AI with supporting rationale.	Hover any tile to see AI reasoning for the current status.
Settings Button (■)	Toggle	Opens Display Settings for font size and color customization.	Click to open/close. Panel appears top-right.
Info Buttons (i)	Toggle	Appear next to panel headers. Explain what each panel does.	Click to open callout. Click elsewhere to close.

LEFT COLUMN

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Media Feed	Auto-display	AI-generated fictional news headlines from local outlets. LIVE badge marks current-turn headlines. Older headlines fade to gray. Reflects public and media perception — use to inform JIC and PIO decisions.	Read-only. Scroll to see older headlines.
Reference Links	Links	Curated doctrine, guidance, and AARs for the active scenario type. Includes FEMA Resilience Hub hazard pages and FEMA Geospatial Resource Center for all scenarios.	Click any link to open in a new tab.
ESF Reference Panel	Interactive	All 15 ESFs with number, name, lead agency, and description. Track which ESFs you have activated during your session.	Click any ESF to mark ACTIVE (green highlight). Click again to deactivate. Player tracking only — AI does not see your selections.
Left Column Dividers	Drag handle	Horizontal drag handles between the three left column panels.	Click and drag up or down to resize panels.

FIELD DISPATCH

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Dispatch Cards	Auto-display	Incoming field reports using named local agencies and local geography. NEW cards (green) are from the current turn. Older cards fade to gray but remain in the log.	Read-only. Scroll to review. New items appear at top each turn.
Dispatch Count Badge	Display	Red badge showing total dispatch items in the log.	Read-only.

SCENARIO TERMINAL

Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Terminal Header	Display	Shows scenario name, generated location, difficulty, selected role, and player name (if entered).	Read-only. Set at scenario launch.
Terminal Log	Display	Main narrative window. Shows player actions (green), AI consequence text (gray with left border), time stamps, and prompts for next action. Auto-scrolls to latest entry.	Read-only.
Situation Status Badge	Display	Color-coded incident trajectory: green (STABLE), yellow (DEVELOPING), orange (CRITICAL), red (DETERIORATING).	Read-only. Updates each turn.
Action Input Box	Text entry	Where you type decisions as your selected role. Be specific — name resources, priorities, who owns what, and what you are communicating. The AI evaluates from your role's perspective.	Click to focus, type, press Enter or click Execute. Shift+Enter for new line. Drag top edge to resize.
Execute Button	Action	Submits your action to the AI for evaluation.	Click, or press Enter.
ENDEX Command	Text command	Type ENDEX to end the scenario and trigger a full After-Action Review calibrated to your role and jurisdiction.	Type ENDEX in the input box and press Execute or Enter.
New Button	Toggle	Opens a dialog to end the current scenario.	Click to open. Choose End with AAR or End without AAR.
Return to Mission Select	Button	Appears after the AAR is delivered. Returns you to the setup screen to begin a new session.	Click after reviewing your AAR.
Input Area Drag Handle	Drag handle	Thin bar above the input area. Resize the input box vertically.	Click and drag up to expand, down to shrink.

RIGHT COLUMN			
Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Commander's Notepad	Free text	Persistent scratch pad. If you entered a name, displays as "[Name]'s Notepad". Saves automatically across browser sessions. Nothing here affects the simulation.	Click and type.
Turn / Difficulty Footer	Display	Current turn number and difficulty level.	Read-only.
Incident Map	Interactive	Live Leaflet map centered on the AI-generated location. Color-coded infrastructure pins at launch, turn-numbered event pins added each turn.	Click any pin for popup details. Zoom and pan freely.
Static Infrastructure Pins	Map layer	Placed at launch from the AI world generation: green (EOC), blue (hospitals), orange (staging), purple (shelters), red (affected/hazmat/fire).	Click to open popup.
Dynamic Event Pins	Map layer	Dark pins with white turn numbers (T1, T2 etc.) placed by AI when dispatch events have physical locations.	Click for popup with label, turn, type, and status.
Right Column Divider	Drag handle	Between the notepad and the map.	Click and drag to resize.

DISPLAY SETTINGS			
Field / Element	Type	What It Does	How to Interact
Font Size Slider	Range	Adjusts base font size across the game screen. Range 9px–16px.	Open Settings via gear button. Drag slider.
Accent Color	Color picker	Highlight color for player text and active elements. Default: teal.	Click swatch or use color picker.
Alert Color	Color picker	Color for timestamps and prompts. Default: amber.	Click swatch or use color picker.
Reset to Defaults	Button	Restores all display settings to factory defaults.	Click Reset to Defaults.